GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

November 21st, 2025
Week 47
Volume 278, Issue 1212

Highlights:

- **Annual event.**
- **Dark challenges.**
- **Pak HKC.**
- **More muted.**
- **Busy times ahead.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change."

– Wayne Dyer

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

FORUMS AND FRICTIONS!

This has been a disastrous week for nearly all the key indicators tracked in this newsletter, including the state of oil futures, freight rates, local steel plate prices, and disastrous currency devaluations (especially in India). To start, oil found itself slipping rather shockingly as it fell to USD 57.68/barrel – a total drop of over 6% in the last month and over 16% lower than the same time last year. As oil slipped, freight rates continued to climb throughout the week, recording a near 9% decline over the course of 30 days and over 48% as compared to November 2024.

At the same time, governments in the U.S. continue their sanctions and blacklist wave as EU members too are reportedly preparing the 20th batch of sanctions against Russia that could authorize member-state navies and coast guards to board shadow-fleet vessels suspected of carrying sanctioned cargoes. The proposal also considers granting third-country flag administrations permission to deregister such vessels and further tighten flag-state cooperation to curb evasive shipping activities. Moreover, the U.S. continues to tighten Iran's economic activities and levy further sanctions that have now wrapped a reported 170 ships in the tangle of global blacklists.

All of this has trickled down to the ship-recycling industry, as not only is supply getting increasingly restricted (as evident from the quantum of the week's deliveries at the various sub-continent waterfronts), but steel plate prices also fell in both Bangladesh and Pakistan, all while Bangladeshi and (especially) Indian currencies staged a late-Thanksgiving horror show this week. As the trading tables went comparatively quiet, much of the industry remained distracted as many gathered in Hong Kong for the annual Tradewinds Ship Recycling Forum. Among the many topics that were hot points of debate were future trends, supply, HKC developments, the dark-fleet problems plaguing the industry, and what possible solutions (if any) lie ahead. It is apparent that what happens with the dark/shadow fleet is of utmost importance given that over 900 vessels are now on the list with no viable exit or strategy for when they come of recyclable age.

Unlike forums of yesteryear, where plenty of trading and recycling deals were concluded on the conference floor, this year was far more muted in terms of deal flow, supply of vessels, and the dampened pricing and demand. The event was well attended by end users, cash buyers, insurers, and lawyers, all expecting (more like hoping, after the performance of the last few years) that vessels across the whole trading spectrum that are approaching 30 years of age and older should see a busy few years of activity in 2026.

Finally, there was some encouraging news with the first Pakistani ship-recycling yard set to receive HKC approval reportedly as early as next week, with another 2–3 set to follow in the next three months, while others are expected by the mid-way point of next year. Bangladesh also reported further yards being certified as the number gradually approaches 20. And Turkey? Your guess is as good as ours.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 47 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

TWENTY UP!

Anorexia

Bangladeshi pricing and demand continue to lead the way across global ship recycling markets, even though there have been very few workable candidates to placate increasingly hungry end users. Although a series of older tankers managed to find their way to end buyers at decent levels over recent weeks and larger LNGs have remained the flavor of late, it has been a far quieter week at the waterfront, much more than many had been expecting, and frustrating given the fact that by this point of the year, the volume of units delivered has been abysmal as the nation continues battling economic anorexia for much of the year.

Some units sold.

With inflation yoyoing around the 8%–9% mark for much of the year and the Bangladeshi Taka (like India) struggling to stabilize itself since June 2024, this week saw the Taka declining over 20 basis points to close the week out at BDT 122.53 against the U.S. Dollar – gradually approaching BDT 123. Local steel plate prices also seem to have hit an oil patch on the road and started declining over recent weeks, including this week, where they fell again, albeit by a marginal USD 1/Ton, as they closed the week out at USD 525.93/Ton.

20 HKC.

Clearly, the unsold volumes of recycled steel that have been piling up at local recycling yards since the summer months have left Chattogram chop shops scrambling to make domestic deals with steel mills even at breakeven levels, unfortunately without much success thus far as, like Pakistan, cheaper imported scrap steel continues to take the limelight. And with the upcoming elections of February 2026 heating up the nation, domestic peace has taken a hit as well, with sporadic reports of political violence sprinkling the national headlines.

SSORP in action.

Meanwhile, another HKC approval has come through this week as the remaining unapproved yards endure infrastructure upgrades, taking the total to 20 approved HKC yards by various bodies (NK, BV, IRS, etc.), and several more are set to follow in the month ahead before year end. In fact, GMS is pleased to report that its Sustainable Ship and Offshore Recycling Program (SSORP) has certainly helped, as free safety and training sessions for workers across India, Bangladesh, and Pakistan have been going on at pace. As of October 2025, the program successfully completed 766 training sessions and reached 11,730 workers on 69 safety and environmental topics.

Overall, it seems 2025 is destined to end just like 2024 – hammered by availability and collapsing prices but with an HKC medal in Chattogram's back pocket.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

LOSING BIG-LY!

Failing to transact.

An anxious and increasingly fraught Indian market has once again failed to successfully transact any serious tonnage this week as recyclers remain reticent to offer, with markets so weak and fundamentals entering a performance comatose on the back of a declining Rupee that fell nearly 1.10% in just five days, closing the week out deep into Rs. 89 territory against the U.S. Dollar at Rs. 89.61. As the currency teeters on the edge of a massive Rs. 90, perennially nervy Alang recyclers have clearly spoken out loud in silence via no meaningful offerings at the bidding tables.

HKC advantage lost.

Local steel plate prices too remain stranded under USD 400/Ton, even though they marked a healthy USD 5/Ton improvement this week, clocking in at USD 398/Ton and further cementing offers for smaller LDT / less-preferred tonnage at well under USD 400/Ton. But even this improvement in steel plate prices remains "too little too late" as the Rupee continues to decimate the sentiments and expectations of delivering deals into Alang that would remain in the green for the ship recycler by the time the vessel(s) arrive(s) and are eventually recycled. The nation's overall economic state too is slipping into stagflation territory, as inflation fell to just 0.25% through October – down from 1.44% in September and well below the 2%–2.5% that the government was hoping to stabilize it at.

Arrowing down.

Meanwhile, adding fuel to the competitive fire are both Pakistan and Bangladesh, who are now at the early stages of catching up with Indian HKC yards. Although Pakistan remains some ways away, it is certainly a matter of time in 2026 when India will start losing its HKC edge. Moreover, in tandem with global stock markets, Indian offerings continue on a downward trajectory and have done so with determination over the last month, as end recyclers grapple with a two-tiered market due to the thorny issue of cheaper-priced dark fleet tonnage being imported, cheap steel from abroad, and even dithering steel prices that are contributing to the local quivering.

Quivering.

With Alang's port position turning bare after a spate of local deliveries this week – down to just one vessel idling at anchorage and no market fixtures reported – the writing is on the wall for Alang as December slowly creeps in.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

MAKEOVER!

Landmark news!

Landmark and encouraging news has emerged from Pakistan this week, with the first domestic ship recycling yard set to be HKC-approved and due for an announcement in the coming week(s) after all audits are signed off and HKC infrastructure upgrade works are reportedly completed. This is certainly revelatory news for a market that led the sub-continent price rankings for a healthy few months in the summer, but has unfortunately fallen behind its sub-continent counterparts ever since the Hong Kong Convention finally came into force on June 26th, 2025.

While several more yards are set to follow with HKC approvals within the next 3–6 months to keep the local momentum moving, another handful are expected to join the fray by the summer of next year as the industry in Pakistan gets the makeover it has been urging for many a year. Yet, this promising news will unlikely deviate any tonnage towards Gadani shores on the back of provisional DASR certifications and approvals.

Mexican stand-off

Moreover, adding to the local negative temperament are the ongoing inflictions from last week that continued into this week as well, with weakening fundamentals and competing (cheaper) steel imports from Iran dragging local steel plate prices down by the week — including this one, where they fell a massive USD 11/Ton to USD 586/Ton — even though they remain the highest in the sub-continent ship recycling industry. The Pakistani Rupee somehow managed to evade a Mexican stand-off against the U.S. Dollar as it recovered nearly 5 basis points and ended the week at a still-high PKR 282.58.

Momentum shifting.

This is also the third week of no fresh arrivals at the waterfront, with the only local delivery being that of a distraught vessel that had been idling for over a month at Gadani's waterfront. And like India, Pakistani recyclers are watching India's pricing movements closely to determine where their next pricing index will land for the coming week(s), resulting in another no-sale week for this market where the Gadani Gang also refrained from offering.

With the overall macro situation on the freight index not helping ship recycling by way of a sustained supply, it is likely Gadani will traverse December much like Alang — waiting for some stability to rein in the maddening state of affairs.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

NOTHING NEW!!

Lira's down another 30+ basis points against the U.S.$. this week and past TRY 42.40 against the U.S. Dollar, steel plate prices are stagnating, demand is suffocating by the supply pillow and there's simply nothing new to talk about right now.

Supply pillow.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 47 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	260 / LDT	270 / LDT	280 / LDT

SPACED OUT!!

- ***All the other planets could fit between Earth and the Moon.*** *Yes, we can see the Moon from Earth and it looks big (compared to the stars and planets, anyway). We've even travelled to the Moon and set foot on it. But the Moon is really far away. It's about 400,000 km or 250,000 miles away, in fact. Scientists have calculated you could fit the other seven planets of our Solar System into the space between Earth and the Moon.*
- ***You could survive a couple of minutes in a leaky spacesuit.*** *Although it would definitely be unpleasant, you could survive for a couple of minutes. After around 10 seconds, you would lose consciousness. The lower pressure of the vacuum would cause your blood to boil, along with other body. But this boiling alone would not be fatal, due to the pressure maintained by our blood vessels themselves. Gas bubbles would form in your bodily fluids, causing your body to swell up and bloat. The low humidity of space would cause you to cool down rapidly, and your eyes may freeze over. Within one to two minutes, the lack of oxygen would be deadly. The stress of the situation may make these symptoms worse – you would become oxygen-deprived more quickly. A rapid decompression would cause damage to your lungs, eardrums and sinuses, along with bruising and bleeding from soft tissues.*
- ***1 tsp of neutron star weighs the same as the human population.*** *A neutron star's density is mind-boggling. These stars are composed almost entirely of neutrons packed together in a tiny radius. Just a teaspoonful of neutron star would weigh over a trillion kilograms. That's more than the weight of the entire human population (which reaches a few hundred billion kilograms). To make something as dense as a neutron star, the whole of humanity would need to be crammed into a space the size of a sugar cube.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 24 – Christmas Eve December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – New Year's Eve	November 18 – November 25 December 02 – December 10 December 18 – December 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 01 – 02 – Durga Puja December 16 – Victory Day December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – Bank Holiday	December 03 – December 06 December 21 – December 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
December 25 – Quaid-e-Azam	**No holidays in December**

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of November 21, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
2	Kai De Star	2,665	Reefer	Arrived November 20
3	*Smurf*	*4,043*	*Heavy Load Carrier*	*Delivered November 19*
4	*Tara*	*3,135*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered November 20*
Total Tonnage		**29,844**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of November 21, 2025

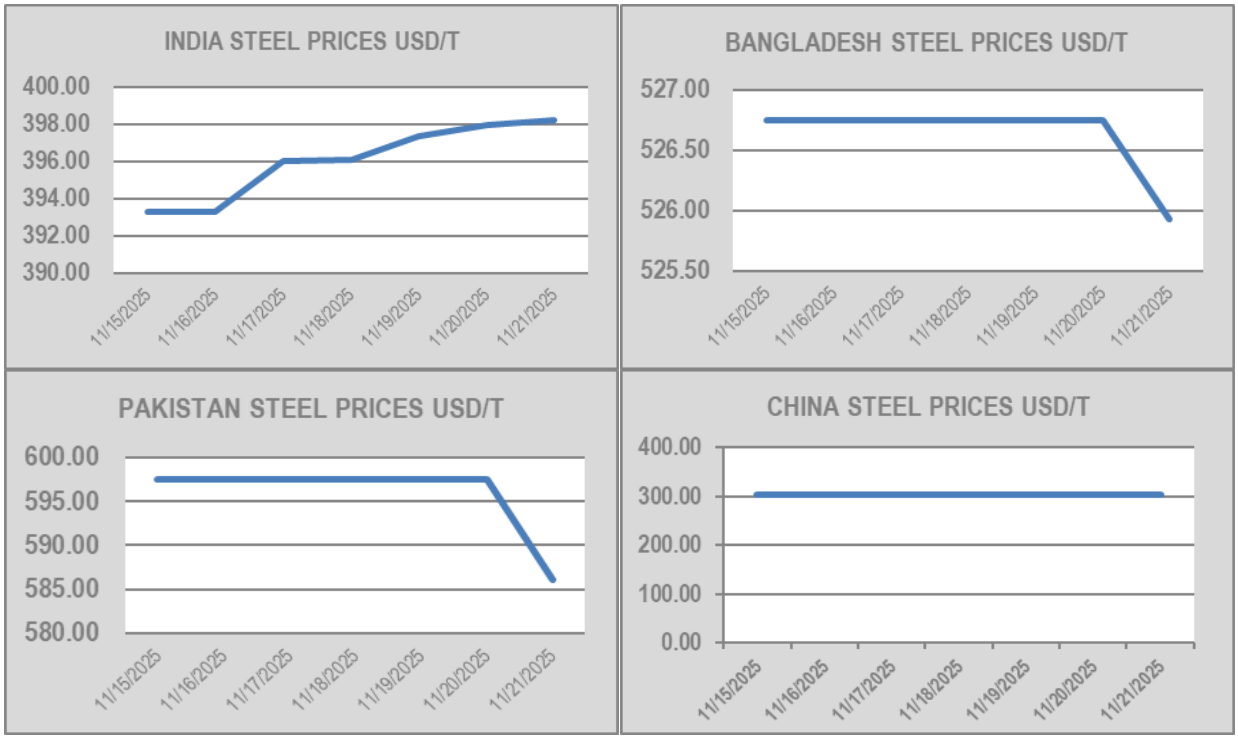
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Fu Ocean*	*21,338*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered November 20*
2	*Guly*	*13,782*	*Tanker*	*Delivered November 19*
3	*Leo*	*1,788*	*Tanker*	*Delivered November 21*
4	*Raissa*	*9,711*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered November 16*
5	*Rana*	*8,082*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered November 19*
6	*Sant Ana*	*8,777*	*Tanker*	*Delivered November 20*
		63,479		

GADANI - Port Position as of November 19, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Eena 1	1,444	General Cargo	Delivered November 19
Total Tonnage		**1,444**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
11/15/2025	393.28	34,900.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	63,900.00	302.86
11/16/2025	393.28	34,900.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	63,900.00	302.86
11/17/2025	396.03	35,100.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	63,900.00	302.86
11/18/2025	396.12	35,100.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	63,000.00	302.86
11/19/2025	397.38	35,200.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	63,000.00	302.86
11/20/2025	397.97	35,300.00	597.44	168,000.00	526.75	62,900.00	302.86
11/21/2025	398.24	35,300.00	586.15	165,000.00	525.93	62,900.00	302.86



www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311